

Standard Chartered (STAN.L/2888.HK): Investor Event First Look: Inline 2028 RoTE targets though opex targets slightly above cons

Standard Chartered has unveiled its mid-term strategic targets, headlined by a Return on Tangible Equity (ROTE) guidance of >15% by 2028 and an ambitious ~18% by 2030. While the 2028 target is largely in line with consensus (15.1%), it remains conservative relative to our estimate of 15.4% in 2027, rising to 16.2% in 2028 and 16.8% in 2029. The 2030 target provides significant assurance of management's commitment to sustained performance. Our income CAGR of 5.9% sits comfortably in the middle of the 5–7% guidance range, whereas consensus remains at the lower bound (5.2%). However, the guided Cost-to-Income Ratio (CIR) of 57% (consensus ~56%) suggests a more cautious outlook on opex than our 54% assumption, implying higher cost growth in the medium term. Based on our 5.9% income CAGR, a 57% CIR target would imply a cost growth of approximately 3.5% for the 2027–2028 period. Base on the guidance:

- **At 5% Income CAGR:** Implied cost growth is ~2.5% for 2027/28.
- **At 7% Income CAGR:** Implied cost growth is ~5.0% for 2027/28.

Our current model assumes a more disciplined 1% opex CAGR. The discrepancy suggests that either the “Fit for Growth” cost-saving benefits may be further pushed back, with the most significant acceleration in efficiency gains likely occurring after 2028 to bridge the gap toward the 18% ROTE target in 2030, or there will be more investment needed in the interim. While the 2026–2028 ROTE guidance does not provide an immediate impetus for upward revisions—given it aligns with consensus—the long-term 2030 target however allows for further delivery from the bank.

STAN's new medium-term targets (2026–28) and beyond to 2030 have been announced:

- **ROTE:** Deliver > 15% ROTE of in 2028 and building up to ~18% in 2030. Company-compiled cons. models 15.1% FY28 ROTE vs. GSe of 16.2% FY28 ROTE.
- **Operating income/EPS:** Deliver 5–7% CAGR (at ccy, ex-notables) for operating income and high-teens CAGR for EPS from FY25–28. Company-compiled cons. for operating income/EPS is ~5%/~18% CAGR vs. GSe ~6%/~21% CAGR for FY25–28.
- **Reported cost:** Generate CIR ratio (ex-notables) of ~57% in FY28 aided by positive income-to-cost jaws. Company-compiled cons. of CIR is at ~56% with

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positive jaws of 4.2ppt p.a. on average for FY26-28 vs. GSe ~54% in FY28 with positive jaws of 5.5ppt p.a. on average for FY26-28 (reported basis).

- **CET1 ratio:** Operate within 13-14% range. Company-compiled cons. models 13.8-14.0% vs. GSe of 13.4%-13.6% for FY26-28.
- **Credit cost:** Guided within 30-35bps through-the-cycle. Company-compiled cons. is 35-36bps vs. GSe of 34-35bps for FY26-28.
- **Capital returns:** Support a dividend payout ratio of 30% or more, with a progressive DPS. Company-compiled cons. of divided payout ratio is 30%/29%/28% vs. GSe of 33%/33%/33% for FY26/27/28.

2026 guidance was also reiterated:

- **Reported operating income** growth y/y to be around the bottom end of 5-7% range (at ccy, ex notables). Implies c.\$21.8bn (at +5% y/y), vs company-compiled cons. \$21.95bn, vs GSe \$22.30bn.
- **Underlying NII** expected to be broadly flat y/y (at ccy). Implies c.\$11.2bn, vs cons. \$11.24bn, vs Gse \$11.35bn.
- **Reported costs** to be broadly flat (at ccy, ex notables), including FFG charges (c.\$0.6bn). Implies c.\$13.2bn, (vs cons \$13.30bn, vs GSe \$13.25bn)
- **Statutory ROTE** >12%, vs cons. 12.5%, vs GSe 13.6%

Guidance for 2027 to be provided at Q4'26 result.

Exhibit 1: GSe vs. Consensus vs. Mgmt Guidance

\$mn, unless otherwise stated	GS			Cons			Mgmt guidance
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	Medium-term and beyond
Net interest income	11,350	11,728	12,277	11,235	11,498	11,888	
Other income	10,953	11,789	12,605	10,716	11,629	12,496	
Operating income	22,303	23,517	24,882	21,951	23,128	24,384	
Operating costs	(13,249)	(12,983)	(13,493)	(13,306)	(13,293)	(13,711)	
PPP	9,054	10,534	11,390	8,644	9,835	10,649	
Loan impairments	(1,010)	(1,091)	(1,134)	(1,011)	(1,075)	(1,140)	
Other impairments	(92)	(120)	(120)	(76)	(54)	(55)	
Associates/JVs	48	48	49	49	50	53	
PBT	7,999	9,371	10,184	7,606	8,756	9,507	
Taxation	(2,122)	(2,671)	(2,902)	(2,163)	(2,440)	(2,633)	
Minorities & AT1	(574)	(574)	(574)	(575)	(573)	(578)	
Profit/(loss) attributable to ordinary shareholders	5,304	6,126	6,707	4,869	5,742	6,297	
Credit cost (bps)	34.3	35.6	35.5	34.6	35.4	36.2	30-35bps through-the-cycle
CET1 ratio	13.4	13.5	13.6	13.8	13.9	14.0	13-14%
Core EPS (\$c)	242.4	295.9	343.1	222.4	277.0	319.8	
DPS (\$c)	81.9	100.1	115.9	68.2	81.3	90.9	
ROTE (Statutory)	13.6%	15.4%	16.2%	12.5%	14.3%	15.1%	>15% in FY28 ~18% by 2030
Customer loans and advances (net) - \$bn	301.6	311.9	326.9	297.9	309.1	320.8	
Risk-weighted assets - \$bn	270.8	278.2	289.9	268.2	278.2	289.1	
Tangible Equity - \$bn	39.0	40.5	42.3	39.5	41.0	42.8	
Growth/ratio targets							
EPS CAGR (25-28E)			21%			18%	High-teens
Operating income CAGR (25-28E)			6%			5%	5-7%
Dividend payout ratio (%)	33%	33%	33%	30%	29%	28%	>30% dividend payout ratio
CIR ratio (%)	59%	55%	54%	61%	57%	56%	~57% in FY28
Jaws ratio (%)	7%	7%	2%	5%	5%	2%	Positive income-to-cost jaws

Company-compiled consensus for 2026/27/28. Consensus is pre Q1'26 results (latest available). STAN 25-28E CAGR guidance for income is at constant currency and ex-notable items, cost-to-income ratio (CIR) is ex-notables — for simplicity, in the table above we show reported CAGR and CIR.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and risks

We are Buy-rated on STAN.L and 2888.HK. Our 12m price target for STAN.L of 2,260p is based on a 10.25x target P/E multiple — with our P/E valuation methodology applied 75%/25% to 2027/28E estimates. Our 12m price target for 2888.HK of HK\$243 is based on a 2-stage dividend discount model. Key downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Disclosure Appendix

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We, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Chris Hallam, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Sachin Nayar and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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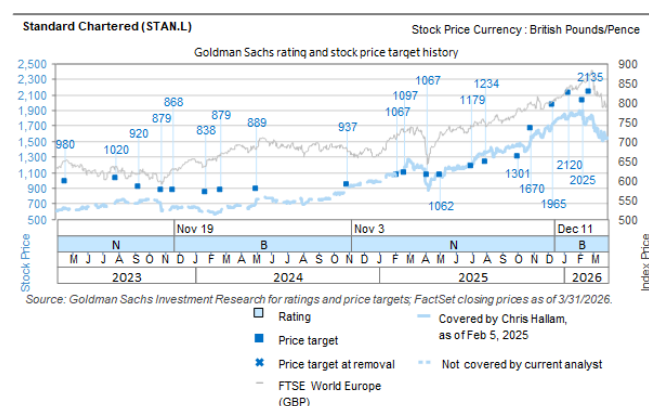
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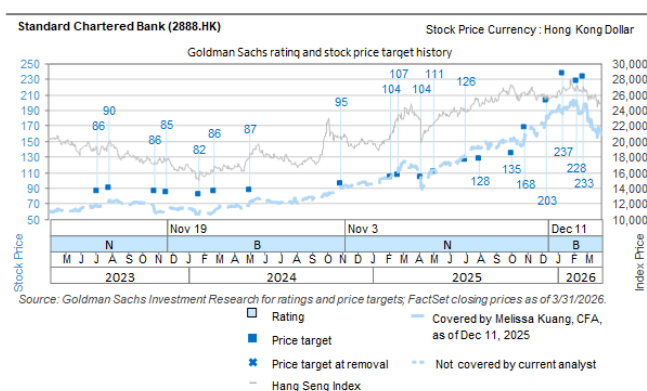
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Target price history table(s)

Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
30-Apr-26	243.00	190.80
21-Apr-26	237.00	192.40
24-Feb-26	233.00	197.90
09-Feb-26	228.00	202.00
13-Jan-26	237.00	191.60
11-Dec-25	203.00	177.00
30-Oct-25	168.00	159.50
03-Oct-25	135.00	152.60
31-Jul-25	128.00	142.00
04-Jul-25	126.00	130.30
02-May-25	111.00	113.60
07-Apr-25	104.00	91.50
21-Feb-25	107.00	116.00
05-Feb-25	104.00	103.60
30-Oct-24	95.00	90.75
02-May-24	87.00	71.95
23-Feb-24	86.00	62.45
23-Jan-24	82.00	58.00
19-Nov-23	85.00	61.30
26-Oct-23	86.00	59.75
28-Jul-23	90.00	74.50
06-Jul-23	86.00	66.55

Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
30-Apr-26	2,260	1,862.8
21-Apr-26	2,165	1,806
24-Feb-26	2,135	1,789
09-Feb-26	2,025	1,899
13-Jan-26	2,120	1,832
11-Dec-25	1,965	1,717
30-Oct-25	1,670	1,571
03-Oct-25	1,301	1,467
31-Jul-25	1,234	1,360.5
04-Jul-25	1,179	1,207
02-May-25	1,062	1,096.5
07-Apr-25	1,067	937.2
21-Feb-25	1,097	1,183
05-Feb-25	1,067	1,074
30-Oct-24	937	912.6
02-May-24	889	756
23-Feb-24	879	635
23-Jan-24	838	605.8
19-Nov-23	868	660
26-Oct-23	879	625.2
12-Sep-23	920	725.4
28-Jul-23	1,020	737.6

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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